

MAKOTO M. KELP

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EDUCATION

Harvard University <i>Ph.D.</i> , Earth and Planetary Sciences <i>S.M.</i> , Environmental Science and Engineering	2018 – 2023
Reed College <i>B.A.</i> , Chemistry	2012 – 2016

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Assistant Professor , University of Utah <i>Department of Atmospheric Sciences, Wilkes Center for Climate Science & Policy</i>	Starting Jan 2026
NOAA Climate & Global Change Postdoctoral Fellow , Stanford University <i>Host: Noah Diffenbaugh</i>	2023 – Present
Graduate Research Assistant , Harvard University <i>Advisors: Daniel Jacob and Loretta Mickley</i>	2018 – 2023
Junior Research Scientist , University of Washington <i>Advisor: Julian Marshall</i>	2016 – 2018

RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research centers on applying machine learning and data-driven methods to uncover new perspectives in atmospheric chemistry and land-climate-human interactions. I place a special emphasis on exploring the interplay among fires, climate, and society.

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

NOAA Climate & Global Change Postdoctoral Fellowship	2023 – 2025
Atmospheric Chemistry Colloquium for Emerging Senior Scientists (ACCESS XVII)	2023
Harvard University Bok Center Certificate of Distinction in Teaching	2019, 2022
AGU Outstanding Student Presentation Award	2019
National Science Foundation STEM Scholar	2013 – 2016

PUBLICATIONS (*SUBMITTED, ADVISEE)

h-index: 12 ([Google Scholar](#))

- *24. Chung, K., T. Liu, **M. Kelp**, K. Vohra, D. Skelly, M. Carroll, J. Schwartz, and L.J. Mickley. Managing Smoke Risk from Wildland Fires: Northern California as a Case Study. (Submitted)
Advised Undergraduate First-Author with T. Liu
- *23. Feng, X., L.J. Mickley, J.O. Kaplan, **M. Kelp**, Y. Li, T. Liu. Large role of anthropogenic climate change in driving smoke exposure across the western United States from 1992 to 2020. (Submitted)
- *22. Hickman, S., **M. Kelp**, P. Griffiths, K. Doerksen, K. Miyazaki, E. Pennington, G. Koren, F. Iglesias-Suarez, M. Schultz, K. Chang, O.R. Cooper, A. Archibald, R. Sommariva, D. Carlson, H. Wang, J. West, and Z. Liu. Applications of Machine Learning and Artificial Intelligence in Tropospheric Ozone Research. (Submitted)
Tropospheric Ozone Assessment Report Phase II (TOAR-II) Community Special Issue
- *21. **Kelp, M.**, M. Burke, M. Qiu, I. Higuera-Mendieta, T. Liu, and N. Diffenbaugh. Efficacy of Recent Prescribed Burning and Land Management on Wildfire Burn Severity and Smoke Emissions in the Western United States. (In review)
- *20. Qiu, M., J. Li, C.F. Gould, R. Jing, **M. Kelp**, M.L. Childs, J. Wen, Y. Xie, M. Lin, M.V. Kiang, S. Heft-Neal, N.S. Diffenbaugh, M. Burke. Wildfire smoke exposure and mortality burden in the US under future climate change. (In review)

19. Qiu, M., D. Chen, **M. Kelp**, J. Li, G. Huang, M.D. Yazdi (2025). The rising threats of wildland-urban interface fires in the era of climate change: The Los Angeles 2025 fires. *The Innovation*, DOI: 10.1016/j.xinn.2025.100835.
18. Kawano, A., **M. Kelp**, M. Qiu, K. Singh, E. Chaturvedi, I. Azevedo, and M. Burke (2025). Improved daily PM_{2.5} estimates in India reveal inequalities in recent enhancement of air quality. *Science Advances*, 11, 4, DOI: sciadv.adq1071.
17. Qiu, M., **M. Kelp**, S. Heft-Neal, X. Jin, C.F. Gould, D.Q. Tong, and M. Burke (2024). Evaluating Estimation Methods for Wildfire Smoke and their Implications for Assessing Health Effects. *Environ. Sci. Technol.*, 58, 52, 22880–22893, DOI: 10.1021/acs.est.4c05922.
Special Issue on “Wildland Fires: Emissions, Chemistry, Contamination, Climate, and Human Health”
16. Liu, T., F.M. Panday, M.C. Caine, **M. Kelp**, D.C. Pendergrass, and L.J. Mickley (2024). Is the smoke aloft? Caveats regarding the use of the Hazard Mapping System (HMS) smoke product as a proxy for surface smoke presence across the United States. *International Journal of Wildland Fire*, 33, WF23148, DOI: 10.1071/WF23148.
15. Lin, H., L.K. Emmons, E.W. Lundgren, L.H. Yang, X. Feng, R. Dang, S. Zhai, Y. Tang, **M. Kelp**, N.K. Colombi, S.D. Eastham, T.M. Fritz, A.M. Fiore, and D.J. Jacob (2024). Intercomparison of GEOS-Chem and CAM-chem tropospheric oxidant chemistry within the Community Earth System Model version 2 (CESM2). *Atmospheric Chemistry and Physics*, 24, 8607–8624, DOI: 10.5194/acp-24-8607-2024.
14. **Kelp, M.**, C. A. Keller, K. Wargan, B.M. Karpowicz, and D. J. Jacob (2023c). Tropospheric ozone data assimilation in the NASA GEOS Composition Forecast modeling system (GEOS-CF v2.0) using satellite data for ozone vertical profiles (MLS), total ozone columns (OMI), and thermal infrared radiances (AIRS, IASI). *Environ. Res. Lett.*, 18, 094036, DOI: 10.1088/1748-9326/acf0b7.
13. **Kelp, M.**, T. C. Fargiano, S. Lin, T. Liu, J.R. Turner, J. N. Kutz, and L.J. Mickley (2023b). Data-driven placement of PM_{2.5} air quality sensors in the United States: an approach to target urban environmental injustice, *GeoHealth*, 7, e2023GH000834, DOI: 10.1029/2023GH000834.
Special Collection on “Geospatial data applications for environmental justice”
12. Balasus, N., D. J. Jacob, A. Lorente, J. D. Maasackers, R. J. Parker, H. Boesch, Z. Chen, **M. Kelp**, H. Nesser, and D. J. Varon (2023). A blended TROPOMI+GOSAT satellite data product for atmospheric methane using machine learning to correct retrieval biases. *Atmos. Meas. Tech.*, 16, 3787–3807, DOI: 10.5194/amt-16-3787-2023.
11. **Kelp, M.**, M. Carroll, T. Liu, R.M. Yantosca, H.E. Hockenberry, and L.J. Mickley (2023a). Prescribed burns as a tool to mitigate future wildfire smoke exposure: Lessons for states and environmental justice communities. *Earth’s Future*, 11, e2022EF003468, DOI: 10.1029/2022EF003468.
10. **Kelp, M.**, D.J. Jacob, H. Lin, and M.P. Sulprizio (2022b). An online-learned neural network chemical solver for stable long-term global simulations of atmospheric chemistry. *JAMES*, 14, e2021MS002926, DOI: 10.1029/2021MS002926.
Selected as Highlight Paper
Special Collection on “Machine learning application to Earth system modeling”
9. Yang, L. H., D.H. Hagan, J.C. Rivera-Rios, **M. Kelp**, E.S. Cross, C.Y. Peng, J. Kaiser, L.R. Williams, P. L. Croteau, J.T. Jayne, and N.L. Ng (2022). Investigating the sources of urban air pollution using low-cost air quality sensors at an urban Atlanta site. *Environ. Sci. Technol.*, 56, 11, 7063–7073, DOI: 10.1021/acs.est.1c07005.
8. **Kelp, M.**, S. Lin, J.N. Kutz, and L.J. Mickley (2022a). A new approach for optimal placement of PM_{2.5} air quality sensors: case study for the contiguous United States. *Environ. Res. Lett.*, 17, 034034, DOI: 10.1088/1748-9326/ac548f.
7. **Kelp, M.**, D.J. Jacob, J.N. Kutz, J.D. Marshall, and C. Tessum (2020b). Toward stable, general machine-learned models of the atmospheric chemical system. *JGR: Atmospheres*, 125, e2020JD032759, DOI: 10.1029/2020JD032759.

6. **Kelp, M.**, T. Gould, E. Austin, J.D. Marshall, M. Yost, C. Simpson, and T. Larson (2020a). Sensitivity analysis of area-wide, mobile source emission factors to high-emitter vehicles in Los Angeles. *Atmospheric Environment*, 223, 117212, DOI: 10.1016/j.atmosenv.2019.117212.
5. Wen, Y., H. Wang, T. Larson, **M. Kelp**, S. Zhang, Y. Wu, and J.D. Marshall (2019). On-highway vehicle emission factors, and spatial patterns, based on mobile monitoring and absolute principal component score. *Science of The Total Environment*, 676, 242-251, DOI: 10.1016/j.scitotenv.2019.04.185.
4. **Kelp, M.**, C. Tessum, and J.D. Marshall (2018b). Orders-of-magnitude speedup in atmospheric chemistry modeling through neural network-based emulation. *arXiv:1808.03874*.
3. **Kelp, M.**, A.P. Grieshop, C.O. Reynolds, J. Baumgartner, G. Jain, K. Sethuramanand, and J.D. Marshall (2018a). Real-time indoor measurement of health and climate-relevant air pollution concentrations during a carbon-finance-approved cookstove intervention in rural India. *Development Engineering*, 3, 125-132, DOI: 10.1016/j.deveng.2018.05.001.
2. Brewer, J. F., M. Bishop, **M. Kelp**, C. Keller, A.R. Ravishankara, and E.V. Fischer (2017). A sensitivity analysis of key factors in the modeled global acetone budget. *J. Geophys. Res.*, 122, DOI: 10.1002/2016JD025935.
1. Jaffe, D., J. Putz, G. Hof, G. Hof, J. Hee, D.A. Lommers-Johnson, F. Gabela, J. Fry, B. Ayres, **M. Kelp**, and M. Minsk (2015). Diesel particulate matter and coal dust from trains in the Columbia River Gorge, Washington state, USA. *Atmospheric Pollution Research*, 6, 946-952, DOI: 10.1016/j.apr.2015.04.004.

INVITED TALKS AND SEMINARS

2025 CPAESS Discovery Series Seminar
 2025 UC Berkeley – CEE Environmental Engineering Seminar
 2024 UC Irvine – Earth System Science
 2024 NOAA Climate and Global Change Summer Institute
 2024 MIT – Civil and Environmental Engineering
 2024 University of Washington – Atmospheric Science and Computer Science
 2024 University of Utah – Atmospheric Science
 2024 AI for the Study of Environmental Risk (AI4ER) seminar, University of Cambridge
 2023 Southwest Fire Science Consortium and Fire Adapted New Mexico Learning Network
 2023 PSEG Institute for Sustainability Studies with The Trust for Public Land, Montclair State University
 2023 Atmospheric Chemistry Colloquium for Emerging Senior Scientists (ACCESS) XVII, Brookhaven National Lab
 2023 NASA GISS
 2023 Columbia University
 2023 Science in the News, Harvard University
 2023 AGU/AMS GeoHealth Showcase
 2023 MIT Atmospheric Chemistry Colloquium
 2023 Stanford University
 2022 Royal Meteorological Society Atmospheric Chemistry Special Interest Conference
 2022 Pennsylvania Department of Environmental Protection Air Monitoring Committee Workshop
 2022 Karlsruhe Institute of Technology
 2022 University of Washington
 2022 University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign Advanced Environmental Engineering Seminar
 2022 EPA Model Applications Team Meeting

SELECTED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS (*INVITED)

2024 AGU Fall Meeting, Washington D.C. (Talk)
 *2024 Health Effects Institute Annual Conference, Philadelphia, PA (Talk)
 2023 AGU Fall Meeting, San Francisco, CA (Talk)

- *2023 Meteorology and Climate - Modeling for Air Quality, Session: “Breakthrough Innovations in Atmospheric & Air Quality Modeling”, UC Davis (Talk)
- 2023 AMS Annual Meeting, Denver, CO (Talk)
- 2022 AGU Fall Meeting, Chicago, IL (Talk)
- *2022 Atmospheric Chemical Mechanisms, Session: “Mechanism Development and Reduction”, UC Davis (Talk)
- 2022 AMS Annual Meeting, Virtual (Talk)
- 2022 10th International GEOS-Chem Meeting, Washington University in St. Louis (Talk)
- *2022 ECMWF Machine Learning Workshop (Talk)
- 2021 AMS Annual Meeting, Virtual (Talk)
- *2020 AGU Fall Meeting, Virtual (Talk)
- 2020 Atmospheric Chemical Mechanisms Conference, Virtual (Talk)
- 2019 AGU Fall Meeting, San Francisco, CA (Poster)
- 2018 AGU Fall Meeting, Washington D.C. (Poster)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Stanford University Civil and Environmental Engineering

CEE265F/SUSTAIN248: Environmental Governance and Climate Resilience

Guest Lecturer

Winter 2025

Harvard University Department of Earth and Planetary Sciences

EPS 200: Graduate-level Atmospheric Chemistry and Physics

Teaching Fellow

Fall 2019, Fall 2020, Fall 2022

Guest Lecturer

Fall 2022

Derek Bok Center for Education & Learning

Teaching Certificate

2023

Reed College Department of Chemistry

Chem 101: Molecular Structure and Properties

Chem 102: Chemical Reactivity

Chem 230: Environmental Chemistry

Laboratory Teaching Assistant

2015-2016

Tutor, Grader

2013-2016

RESEARCH MENTORING

Undergraduates:

- Nia McKenzie (Summer 2025, Spelman College): “Developing a comprehensive and centralized database of prescribed fire in the United States”
- Emily Jones (Summer 2025, Stanford University): “Tracking Air Pollution from Unregulated Emissions at NASCAR Races and NFL Tailgates”
- Jason Hu (Winter 2025 – Spring 2025, Stanford University): “Machine learning transformers for embedded atmospheric chemistry solvers”
- Rebecca Sandoval (Summer 2024, University of California, Santa Barbara): “Evaluating prescribed fire emissions in California”
- Lyna Kim (Spring 2024 –present, Stanford University): “Physically interpretable machine learning for climate and weather forecasting”
 - ★ Poster presentation at AGU Fall Meeting (2024)
- Christian Chiu (Summer 2023 – Fall 2023, Harvard University): “Uncovering latent VOC emissions and spatiotemporal drivers of urban ozone in changing NO_x regimes”
- Karina Chung (Summer 2023 – Fall 2024, Harvard University): “Google Earth Engine applications for wildfire smoke risk in the Western United States”
 - ★ Lead author of Chung et al. (2025; submitted)

- ★ Selected for AGU/AMS Climate and Health Showcase (2024)
- ★ Oral presentation at AGU Fall Meeting (2023)
- Greta Schultz (Summer 2023, University of Wisconsin-Madison): *“Emergency mobile monitoring for California wildfire smoke”*
 - ★ Poster presentation at AMS Annual Meeting (2024)
- Timothy Fargiano (Summer 2022 – Fall 2022, Harvard University): *“Optimal placement of PM_{2.5} air quality sensors in the US: An approach to target environmental injustice”*
 - ★ Coauthor on Kelp et al. (2023b)
- Margaret Schultz (January 2022 – December 2022, Harvard University): *“Real-time high-resolution downscaling of fine particulate matter (PM_{2.5}) air quality in the United States using machine learning”*
 - ★ Year-long environmental engineering senior thesis: [senior project spotlight](#)
- Sanjna Kedia (Summer 2022, Harvard University): *“Machine learning for automated detection of wildfire smoke in the US”*
- Samuel Lin (Summer 2021- Fall 2021, Harvard University): *“Optimal air quality sensor placement in the United States”*
 - ★ Coauthor on Kelp et al. (2023b, 2022a)
- Marie Panday (Summer 2021, University of Maryland): *“Trends in and Reconstruction of Smoke Days across the United States”*
 - ★ Coauthor on Liu et al. (2024)
- Kent Toshima (Summer 2020 - Summer 2021, Harvard University): *“Application of deep learning to detection of wildfire smoke in HMS over North America”*
- Miah Caine (Summer 2020 - Spring 2021, Harvard University): *“Agreement between the HMS Product and Ground-Level Smoke in the Pacific Northwest”*
 - ★ Coauthor on Liu et al. (2024)

Committees as member:

- Vanessa Sun (UU ATMOS), PhD Committee 2024-

SYNERGISTIC ACTIVITIES

International:

Co-Chair for Tropospheric Ozone Assessment Report, Phase II (TOAR-II) Machine Learning for Tropospheric Ozone (ML4O3) Working Group (2023 – Present)

Co-leader of [Statistical Learning in Atmospheric Chemistry \(SLAC\)](#) group, seminar series (2022 – Present)

Proposal reviewer for NASA (2022, 2024), NSF (2023, 2024), Spark Climate Solutions (2024)

Peer reviewer for *Science, Atmospheric Chemistry and Physics, Environmental Research Letters, JAMES, GeoHealth, Environmental Science & Technology, Earth’s Future, ES&T Air, Geoscientific Model Development, Nature Ecology & Evolution, ACS Earth and Space Chemistry, Communications Earth & Environment, Environmental Research Communications, Atmospheric Pollution Research, Environmental Data Science, Environmental Science, and Pollution Research*

National:

Co-Chair for Atmospheric Chemistry Gordon Research Seminar (GRS) (Summer 2025)

Technical Program Committee for Atmospheric Chemical Mechanisms conference (Dec 4-6, 2024)

Session Convener at AGU Fall Meeting:

- Data-Driven Methods for Quantifying Atmospheric Composition: Advances in Computation and Statistical Learning, co-convener (2023, 2024)
- Managing Air Quality and Public Health Under Climate Change: Health Impacts, Mitigation Policy, and Adaptation Strategies, co-convener (2024)
- Prescribed Fires and Land Management in North America, primary convener (2023)

OSPA Judge at AGU Fall Meeting (2023, 2024)

University, Departmental:

DEI Liaison on behalf of postdocs in the Stanford Earth System Science Department (2023-2025)

– Nominated for a 2024 Stanford Postdoc JEDI (Justice, Equity, Diversity and Inclusion) Champion award

Co-leader of Machine Learning & Data Science Subgroup, Harvard Atmospheric Chemistry Modeling Group (2021 – 2023)

Organizer Harvard EPS Department G2 Quads Committee (2020-2021)

Organizer Harvard EPS Department Visiting Scholar Lecture Series Committee (2018 – 2019)

Press:

- Online machine learning in GEOS-Chem: [Editor's Highlight in JAMES](#)
- Prescribed fires: [Press release](#), [Harvard Gazette](#), [KCRA Sacramento](#), [CBS Newspath](#), [Missoulian](#)